INB INDIA NETWORK BULLETIN · EDITION 020

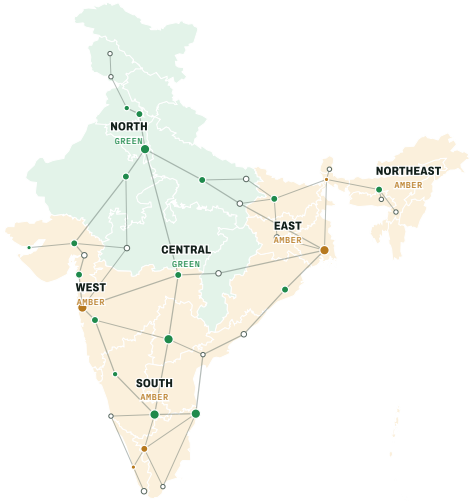
MONDAY 26 OCTOBER 2026 · 09:12 IST

Mid-distance sale parcels have till Wednesday; Kolhapur's cane stays uncut

● NETWORK: AMBER

Amazon's own plan for delivery before Diwali closes standard handovers for mid-distance parcels on Wednesday, so the far-off orders have to be in the network this week[1]. That is also the day the storm is due ashore, and Andhra is clearing its coast by Tuesday. And in Kolhapur, farmers are keeping the cane harvest, and the sugar mills with it, shut.

HOW'S EACH REGION HOLDING UP?



Map: DataMeet, CC BY 4.0

DATES TO WATCH

● Mon 26 Oct	Karnataka cane price meeting in Belagavi
● 26–27 Oct	Kolkata immersion curbs on goods vehicles
● 26 Oct–5 Nov	NH-10 night closures
● 26 Oct–7 Nov	NH-85 Adimali–Munnar shut
● Tue 27 Oct	Karnataka bandh threatened by cane farmers
● Wed 28 Oct	Very severe cyclone crosses the Andhra coast
● 28–29 Oct	Odisha's southern schools shut for the cyclone
● Wed 28 Oct	Amazon's last standard mid-distance handover
● Fri 30 Oct	Amazon's last standard short-distance handover
● Sun 1 Nov	Delhi admits only BS-VI or cleaner outside goods vehicles

● GREEN the sale season as usual, which can still be busy

● AMBER something beyond the season is slowing freight

● RED something is stopping freight across a state or a route

North ● GREEN

Ludhiana, Jaipur and Lucknow hubs run to the season's pattern, with no delay beyond the season.

West ● AMBER

Nhava Sheva's rail backlog is down a quarter in a week: 3,304 TEU sat at the port for depot trains on Sunday, against 4,379 on the 19th[2,3]. I'd expect the inland depots' wait to shrink to an ordinary day's by the weekend, if the queue keeps falling at this pace.

South ● AMBER

Nine Tamil Nadu and Puducherry ports, Chennai and Thoothukudi among them, have hoisted cyclone warning signals as the storm passes offshore[4]. I'd expect the Vijayawada and Visakhapatnam hubs to stop taking coastal loads from Tuesday night, and Hyderabad's coast-bound parcels to run two days late into the weekend.

East ● AMBER

Odisha expects its five districts on the Andhra border, Koraput and Rayagada among them, to take the cyclone's worst[5]. Kolkata's goods vehicle curbs for the last immersions end on Tuesday night[6]. I'd expect trucks for Koraput and Rayagada to be held at Berhampur and Raipur through Wednesday and Thursday, a two-day slip for south Odisha.

Northeast ● AMBER

Gangtok-bound trucks lose the nights from today, while NHIDCL's slope repairs close NH-10 after dark[7]. I'd expect Gangtok's festive stock to move by day only for the fortnight, a day slower for any load leaving Siliguri after noon.

Central ● GREEN

Central India's hubs, Nagpur to Bhopal, carry ordinary festive volumes with no delay beyond the season.

DECISIONS FOR THE WEEK AHEAD, 26 OCT – 1 NOV

1. Andhra plans to have its coastal families in shelters by Tuesday, ahead of a storm IMD now rates very severe at landfall between Bapatla and Visakhapatnam on Wednesday forenoon[5]. A load that reaches the Vijayawada or Visakhapatnam hubs by Tuesday evening sits under a roof when the storm comes in; one still out on NH-16 does not. **Which loads for coastal Andhra and south Odisha go out today and tomorrow, and which wait till the storm has crossed on 28th October (Wednesday)?**

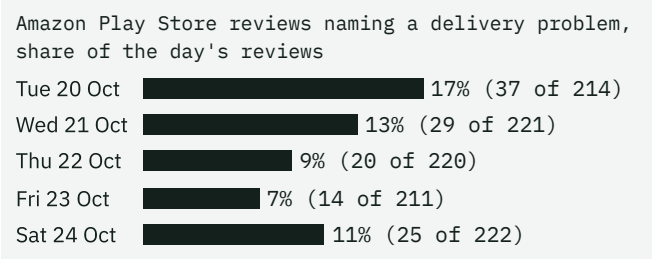
2. The Chief Minister sees mill owners at 11 am today in Belagavi and cane growers at 3.30 pm, and farmer leader Chunappa Pujari says a Karnataka bandh follows on Tuesday if the demands go unmet[8,9]. So the answer comes only this evening, and a bandh holds a truck wherever it stands: Bengaluru's loads for Hubballi and Belagavi have the most to lose. **Do Bengaluru's loads for north Karnataka leave before the growers' talks end this evening, or wait for the farmers' call on 27th October (Tuesday)?**

3. From Sunday, goods vehicles registered outside Delhi need BS-VI or cleaner engines to enter the city, Gurugram's traffic police have confirmed[10]. Diwali stock is still moving into the city, so a BS-IV truck turned back at the border on Sunday is a load lost for the festival's last week. **Which Delhi deliveries on BS-IV trucks are finished, or moved to BS-VI, CNG or electric trucks, before the rule starts on 1st November (Sunday)?**

NETWORK INSIGHTS

1 Amazon's plan for delivery by 5 November closes standard mid-distance handovers on Wednesday

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE



Amazon Shipping's Diwali plan works back from delivery by Thursday 5 November: remote and rural pin codes closed on Saturday, and standard mid-distance lanes close on Wednesday[1]. Short-distance lanes follow on Friday, and express runs to 3 November. So the far-off parcels have to be inside the network this week. The bit that worries me is that complaints are still running high: 25 of 222 Amazon Play Store reviews on Saturday named a delivery problem, back up from 14 of 211 on Friday[11]. I'd expect the hubs to carry the mid-distance wave on Tuesday and Wednesday, and late-delivery complaints to peak from the weekend, as those parcels reach the last mile.

> **Brands selling online that miss Wednesday's handover on standard service pay for express, or deliver after the first Diwali shopping days. Carriers and 3PLs carry the mid-distance wave in the same two days as the east coast storm, so their Chennai–Kolkata linehaul has the least slack of the season.**

2 Only two container ships sailed into the Gulf in a week, down from five

Mundra and Nhava Sheva exporters → Gulf ports

AMBER · HIGH COST OF DELAY · MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

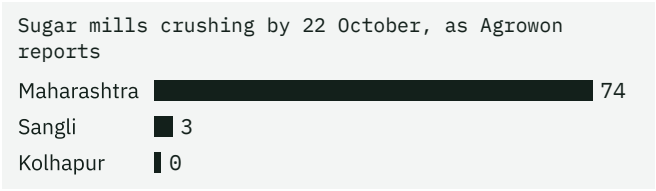
Exporters' boxes to West Asian ports now cost $8,000 to $10,000 against $800 before, FIEO's director general told The Times of India[12]. Drewry counts only two container ships sailing into the Gulf in the week to 18 October, down from five. Who pays? Buyers coped so far because they were short of stock, he says, and now that they are stocked up, it is unclear they can absorb more. I'd expect Gulf-bound boxes at Mundra and Nhava Sheva to wait a week or more for space, and some exporters to hold shipments till after Diwali.

> **Manufacturers and exporters selling to the Gulf pay freight up to ten times its old level, and risk orders their buyers no longer need. Carriers and 3PLs moving those boxes to Mundra and Nhava Sheva see them held at the port while sailings stay scarce.**

3 Kolhapur's sugar mills have not started, as farmers stop the cane harvest

Kolhapur and Sangli cane fields → mills → sugar for the Diwali trade

AMBER · HIGH COST OF DELAY · MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

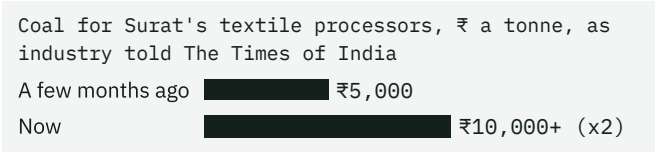


No mill in Kolhapur district had started crushing by 22 October, and only three in Sangli, as farmers' groups stop cane cutting and transport every day, Agrowon reports[13]. Across Maharashtra, 74 mills had crushed 2.5 million tonnes by then. On Sunday Raju Shetti gave the mills a four-day ultimatum, asking ₹4,500 a tonne up front, and told farmers not to let the harvest begin[14]. So who blinks first? Not the farmers, it seems: leaders from Karnataka rode with him and vowed to keep their own mills shut. I'd expect the two districts' cane, and the sugar it makes, to stay off the roads at least till Thursday, and the NH-48 belt round Kolhapur and Belagavi to see protest stoppages through the week.

> **Manufacturers who buy sugar before Diwali, sweet and drink makers among them, wait on mills elsewhere while the border belt stands idle. Carriers and 3PLs with cane-season trucks parked in Kolhapur earn nothing until the price is settled.**

4 Surat's textile processors pay twice as much for coal, and pass on about 10%

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE

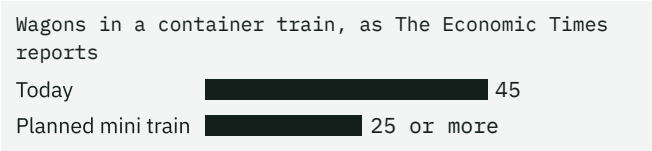


Coal for Surat's textile processors has doubled to more than ₹10,000 a tonne in a few months, from about ₹5,000, raising their processing costs over 20%, industry representatives told The Times of India[15]. Processors have passed on around 10% of it. Mill owners fear they may have to cut output. What does that do to freight? I'd expect fewer fabric pickups from Surat's mills in the first week of November if coal stays where it is, just as Diwali's last orders come in.

> **Brands selling online in apparel, and the manufacturers behind them, face late or costlier fabric as Diwali orders peak. Carriers and 3PLs serving Surat's textile belt may see fewer pickups, while their own diesel and toll bills stay the same.**

5 Railways plans 25-wagon container trains, and stops weighing every export box

MEDIUM CONFIDENCE



Indian Railways will stop weighing every box on some container exports, a check that holds boxes at the depot, and test 5% of trains at random instead, an official told The Economic Times[16]. It also plans mini container trains of at least 25 wagons, against about 750 trains of 45 wagons today, and more hub-and-spoke container terminals. When? None of it has a start date yet. I'd expect the shorter trains to matter most at inland depots that wait days to fill a 45-wagon train.

> **Manufacturers and exporters far from the coast could send smaller lots by rail without waiting for a full train. Carriers and 3PLs trucking boxes to the ports could lose some of that trade to rail.**

THE LANES I'M WATCHING

NH-181 Mettupalayam–Ooty ghat roads

● AMBER

CLOSED TO TRAFFIC OVERNIGHT AFTER MUDSLIDES

Mudslides blocked the Ooty–Mettupalayam and Ooty–Coonoor highways with more than 200 vehicles stranded, and the district now closes its vulnerable ghat routes from 6 pm to 7 am, Hindustan Times reports[17]. I'd expect the Nilgiris' tea and vegetable trucks to keep to daylight runs into Mettupalayam till Wednesday, reaching Coimbatore's markets half a day late.

NH-85 Adimali–Munnar

● AMBER

SHUT FOR TWO MORE WEEKS AFTER A SECOND LANDSLIP

A second landslip at Karadippara on Friday damaged the retaining wall, so Idukki's Collector has kept the road fully shut for another two weeks, and officials say the rebuild may take longer[18]. Traffic takes a detour by Iruttukanam and Anachal. I'd expect Munnar's tea and spice trucks to run an hour or two slower each way until mid-November.

NH-112 Petrapole–Benapole border

● AMBER

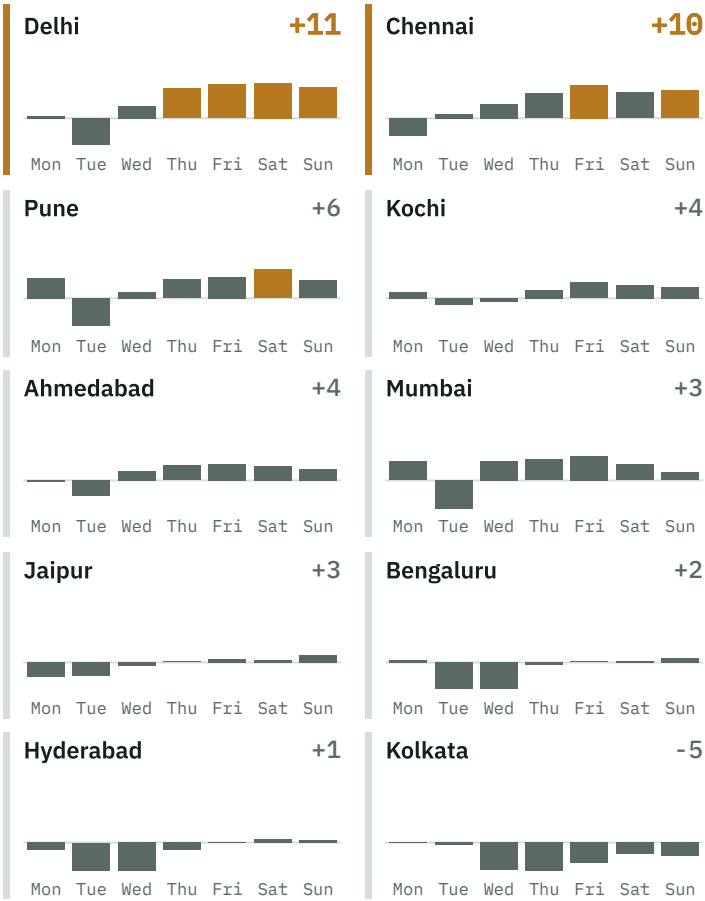
OPEN AGAIN AFTER THE PUJA BREAK, CLEARING A BACKLOG

Benapole took in 256 truckloads of Indian goods on Sunday, its first full day back after eight days shut for the Puja holidays, as traders worked through the backlog on both sides[19]. Saturday's restart managed only 62, held up by a server fault. I'd expect the Bongaon queue to clear by Thursday, and exporters' trucks booked this week to wait a day less each day until then.

CITY TRAFFIC UPDATES

City roads against usual, daily, 19–25 Oct[20] amber = 10+ over

In Delhi, the four busy days from Thursday came while one Old RTR flyover carriageway, from the airport towards Vasant Vihar, was shut until Sunday[21]. Chennai's lift from Thursday came as IMD forecast heavy rain till the 27th and schools closed[22].



CALLS I'LL CHECK NEXT WEEK

1. IMD reports the cyclone crossing the coast between Bapatla and Visakhapatnam on 28th October[23].
2. Benapole takes in more than 300 truckloads of Indian goods on at least one day before 1st November[19].
3. JNPA's import boxes waiting for inland trains fall below 3,000 TEU in its report of 1st November[2].

HOW MY CALLS HAVE DONE

Of the 8 calls scored so far, 6 came true, 1 partly and 1 didn't. 1 is still open. From 19 Oct:

1. Kolkata's roads run 10 or more points over usual on at least three of the five immersion days, 20th–24th October. **Wrong.** Kolkata ran 6 to 23 points below usual by day on all five, by TomTom's hourly readings. Source
2. IMD reports a low over the southeast Bay of Bengal by 26th October (Monday). **Right.** IMD reported a depression over the Bay on the 24th, two days early. Source
3. JNPA's import boxes waiting for trains are still above 3,000 TEU in its report of 25th October. **Right.** 3,304 TEU waited for inland trains on the 25th. Source

HOW THIS IS MADE

At 7 every morning, Claude drafts this page on its own using data available from public sources only. It reads the morning's public signals: city traffic in ten cities, the JNPA and Paradip port reports, ship queues at the container ports, toll-plaza truck counts, the seasonal calendar and about twenty news searches.

Then it writes, and a set of checks decides whether the draft is even fit for me to read. Every claim has to be opened and cited, and no source can be over a week old without a reason. No story from the last seven days comes back unless it actually moved, and nothing gets said twice.

I read it, argue with it, fix what's wrong and approve it. The ratings are my judgement on the likelihood of on-time delivery or cost-impact, not measured service levels or actual cost estimates. Confidence is High when the facts are dated and primary or measured, Medium when they rest on a proxy or a forecast. Does that make the page right? Not always, which is why the calls get scored.

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SOURCES

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